

Structure: Sentences and Types of Sentences

Meaning of a Sentence

A sentence is a group of words arranged in the correct order that makes complete sense. A sentence begins with a capital letter and ends with a punctuation mark such as a full stop (.), question mark (?) or exclamation mark (!).

Examples:

The boy is reading a book.

Where are you going?

What a beautiful day!

Structure of a Sentence

A sentence is made up of two main parts:

Subject – the person, animal, place, or thing being talked about.

Predicate – what is said about the subject.

Example:

The girl sings well.

Subject: The girl

Predicate: sings well

Types of Sentences by Function

1. Declarative Sentence

A sentence that makes a statement or gives information.

Examples:

I live in Abuja.

The sun rises in the east.

2. Interrogative Sentence

A sentence that asks a question

Examples:

Where is my bag?

Are you coming today?

3. Imperative Sentence

A sentence that gives a command, request, or advice.

Examples:

Sit down.

Please help me.

4. Exclamatory Sentence

A sentence that shows strong feeling or emotion.

Examples:

Hurray! We won the match!

What a lovely dress!

Types of Sentences by Structure

1. Simple Sentence

A sentence with one independent clause.

Examples:

She is cooking.

The dog barked.

2. Compound Sentence

A sentence with two or more independent clauses joined by conjunctions like and, but, or.

Examples:

I wanted to play, but it rained.

He read a book and she wrote a letter.

3. Complex Sentence

A sentence with one independent clause and one or more dependent clauses.

Examples:

I stayed indoors because it was raining.

When the bell rang, the pupils entered the class.

4. Compound-Complex Sentence

A sentence with two or more independent clauses and at least one dependent clause.

Example:

I went home, and my sister stayed back because she had work.

Importance of Sentences

Sentences help us express ideas clearly.

They make communication meaningful.

They improve speaking and writing skills.